75. The author of the passage seems to suggest that

(a) it is possible to adjust oneself to uncongenial surroundings.

(b) the conditions in Indian prisons are not bad.

(c) it is not difficult to spend one's time in a prison.

(d) there is a need to improve the conditions in our jails.

Ans. (a) The author of the passage seems to suggest that it is possible to adjust oneself to uncongenial surroundings.

Passage—2

We started pitching the highest camp that has ever been made. Everything took five times as long as it would have taken in a place where there was enough air to breathe; but at last we got the tent up, and when we crawled in, it was not too bad. There was only a light wind, and inside it was not too cold for us to take off our gloves. At night most climbers take off their boots; but I prefer to keep them on. Hillary, on the other hand, took his off and laid them next to his sleeping bag.

76. What does the expression ``pitching the highest camp" imply?

(a) They reached the summit of the highest mountain in the world.

(b) Those who climbed that far earlier did not pitch any camp.

(c) So far nobody has ever climbed that high.

(d) They were too many climbers and needed to pitch a big camp.

Ans. (c) The writer started pitching to highest camp that has ever been made the expression, "Pitching the highest camp", imply those who climbed that for earlier did not pitch any camp.

77. They took a long time to finish the work because

(a) they were very tired.

(b) there was not enough air to breathe

(c) it was very cold

(d) it was very dark.

Ans. (b) They took a long time to finish the work because at height there was not enough air to breath. Everything took five minutes as long as it would have taken in place where there was enough air to breath.

78. When they crawled into the tent

(a) they took off their gloves because it was not very cold.

(b) they could not take off their gloves because it was very cold.

(c) they took off their gloves though it was very cold.

(d) they did not take off their gloves though it was not cold.

Ans. (a) When they crawled into the tent, they took off their gloves because it was not very cold at night, thus most climbers take of their boots but the writer prefer to keep them on.

Passage—3

A local man, staying on the top floor of an old wooden house, was awakened at midnight by a fire. Losing his way in a smoke-filled passage, he missed the stairway and went into another room. He picked up a bundle to protect his face from the fire and immediately fell through the floor below where he managed to escape through a clear doorway. The ``bundle" proved to be the baby of the Mayor's wife. The ``hero" was congratulated by all.

79. The man went into another room because

(a) he did not know where exactly the stairway was.

(b) the passage was full of smoke.

(c) he was extremely nervous.

(d) he stumbled on a bundle.

Ans. (b) The man went into another room because the passage was full of smoke. That's why he missed the stair way and went into another room.

80. The man was called a hero because he

(a) expressed his willingness to risk his life to save others.

(b) managed to escape from the fire

(c) showed great courage in fighting the fire.

(d) saved a life.

Ans. (d) The man was called a hero because he saved a life. He picked up a bundle to protect his face from the fire and immediately fell through the floor below where he managed to escape through a clear doorway. The "bundle" proved to be the baby of the Mayor's wife.

UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2013

CSAT : PAPER-II

(Chapterwise Analysis with Explanation)

Time : 2 hours **Maximum Number : 200**

COMPREHENSION

Directions for the following 2 (two) items :

Read the following passage and answer the two items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage

Ecological research over the last quarter of the century has established the deleterious effects of habitat fragmentation due to mining, highways and such other intrusions on forests. When a large block of forests gets fragmented into smaller bits, the edges of all these bits come into contact with human activities resulting in the degradation of the entire forests. Continuity of forested landscapes and corridors gets disrupted affecting several extinction prone species of wildlife. Habitat fragmentation is therefore considered as the most serious threat to biodiversity conservation. Ad hoc grants of forest lands to mining companies coupled with rampant illegal mining is aggravating this threat.

1. What is the central focus of this passage

(a) Illegal mining in forests

(b) Extinction of wildlife

(c) Conservation of nature

(d) Disruption of habitat

Ans. (d) The central focus of this passage is disruption of habitat. The deleterious effects of habitat fragmentation due to mining, highway and such other intrusion forest. Continuity of forested landscapes and corridors gets disrupted affecting several extinction prone species of wildlife. Thus in present we can see the disruption of habitat.

2. What is the purpose of maintaining the continuity of forested landscapes and corridors ?

1. Preservation of biodiversity.
2. Management of mineral resources.
3. Grant of forest lands for human activities

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2

(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : The purpose of maintaining the continuity of forested landscapes and corridors is preservation of biodiversity. The deleterious effects of habitat fragmentation due to mining, highway and such other intrusion of forest when a larger block of forests gets fragmented into smaller bits, the edges of these bits come into contact with human activities resulting in degradation of entire forest and continuity of forested landscape and corridor thus gets disrupted affecting several extinction prone species of wildlife.

Directions for the following 7 (seven) items :

Read the following two passage and answer the items that follow each passage. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage -1

The law in many parts of the world increasingly restricts the discharge of agricultural slurry into watercourses. The simplest and often the most economically sound practice returns and material to the land as semisolid manure or as sprayed slurry. This dilutes its concentration in the environment to what might have occurred in a more primitive and sustainable type of agriculture and converts pollutant into fertilizer. Soil microorganisms decompose the organic components of sewage and slurry and most of the mineral nutrients become available to be absorbed again by the vegetation.

The excess input of nutrients, both nitrogen and phosphorus-based, from agricultural runoff (and human sewage) has caused many 'healthy' *oligotrophic* lakes (low nutrient concentrations. low plant productivity with abundant water weeds and clear water) to change to *eutrophic* condition where high nutrient inputs lead to high phytoplankton productivity (Sometimes dominated by bloom-forming toxic species). This makes the water turbid, eliminates large plant and, in the worst situations, leads to anoxia and fish kills; so called *cultural* eutrophication. Thus, important ecosystem services are lost, including the provisioning service of wild-caught fish and the cultural services associated with recreation .

The process of cultural eutrophication of lakes has been understood for some time. But only recently did scientists notice huge' dead zones' in the oceans near river outlets, particularly those draining large catchments areas such as the Mississippi in North America and the Yangtze in China. The nutrient enriched water flows through streams, rivers and lakes, and eventually to the estuary and ocean where the ecological impact may be huge, killing virtually all invertebrates and fish in areas up to 70,000 km^2 in extent. More than 150 sea areas worldwide are now regularly starved of oxygen as a result of decomposition of algal blooms, fuelled particularly by nitrogen from agricultural runoff of fertilizers and sewage from large cities. Oceanic dead zones are typically associated with industrialized nations and usually lie off countries that subsidize their agriculture, encouraging farmers to increase productivity and use more fertilizer.